

Sam Walton stopped working for money a long time ago. So did Armand Hammer, Lee Iacocca, Lawrence Tisch, and Frank Sinatra. So did 4 million others, according to the Federal Reserve Board numbers we mentioned in chapter 1. Those millions of people work for power, prestige, status, and a sense of belonging. They work for "attaboys." They play the game and they like winning. They identify with their jobs. In a very real sense they are what they do—and they love it.

But we can't all be Sam Walton or Armand Hammer. We'd like to stay charged up and turned on like we were when we were 25. But most of us reach a plateau, when we know we have little chance of getting another promotion. And we're vulnerable to new waves of baby boomers challenging us from below. Head hunters say we're most vulnerable from age 42 to 50. Before that we're not making enough money for anyone to notice. After that we can be eased into a retirement program. But between 42 and 50 we're most likely to be fired in a 10 percent or 20 percent across-the-board cutback.

Even if you get a big break by age 50, you still face the Peggy Lee Syndrome. The syndrome gets its name from the song Peggy Lee made famous: "Is That All There Is?" Peggy Lee Syndrome hits many of us at age 40 or so, when we look back on our lives and know we missed something. At the same time we look forward and find that, whatever it is, we're going to continue to miss it in the future.

Has it happened to you? Can you believe it *could* happen to you?

In *Passages* (Dutton, 1976), Gail Sheehy's book about life's turning points, Sheehy says that midlife crisis is inevitable. "Whatever rung of achievement he has reached, the man of 40 usually feels stale, restless, burdened, and unappreciated." The game was fun, but the fun part is over. The rest of one's career, in the absence of a sharp change, becomes a